“INTRODUCTION TO PARAGRAPH WRITING”

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Functional English (SS1012)

What is a Paragraph?

A paragraph is often defined as a group of related sentences in which one single, main idea is developed. In a typical paragraph, the first sentence declares the main topic of the paragraph and the rest of the sentences develop or support the main idea. A paragraph is most often a part of a longer composition comprising of several paragraphs.



Type	Purpose	Characteristics	Example
Descriptive Paragraph	To describe a person, place, object, or event in detail.	Uses vivid language and sensory details.	The garden was a vibrant tapestry of colours, with blooming roses and the sweet scent of jasmine filling the air.
Narrative Paragraph	To tell a story or recount an event.	Includes characters, a plot, and a sequence of events.	One sunny afternoon, Emma took a walk in the park and met a dog playing fetch with its owner.
Expository Paragraph	To explain or inform about a topic.	Presents facts, statistics, and explanations without opinions.	Photosynthesis converts sunlight, carbon dioxide, and water into glucose and oxygen in plant cells.
Persuasive Paragraph	To convince the reader of a point of view.	Presents an argument with supporting evidence.	Adopting a plant-based diet reduces chronic disease risks and has a lower carbon footprint.

Compare and Contrast Paragraph	To highlight similarities and differences.	Organizes information by comparing and contrasting features.	Cats are independent and low-maintenance, while dogs require more attention and exercise.
Cause and Effect Paragraph	To explain reasons and outcomes.	Shows the relationship between causes and effects.	Rising greenhouse gases cause global warming, leading to melting ice caps and rising sea levels.

Paragraph Writing Format

- **Structure of a Paragraph:**

  A paragraph has three major parts:

  - Topic sentence
  - Supporting sentences
  - Concluding sentence



TOPIC SENTENCE!

- **What is it?**

Usually the first sentence in a paragraph

- **What does it do?**

It introduces the main idea of the paragraph

- **How do I write one?**

Summarize the main idea of the paragraph



Topic Sentence:

- This is usually the first sentence of a paragraph and serves as its main idea or focus. It tells the reader what the paragraph will be about. A strong topic sentence is clear and specific, setting the stage for the information that will follow.

- For example, if you're writing about the benefits of exercise, your topic sentence might be, "Regular exercise improves overall health in several important ways."

SUPPORTING DETAILS

- **What are supporting details?**

  They are an elaboration of the main idea.

  They make up the body of the paragraph
- **What do they do?**

  They give details and support the main idea
- **How do I write them?**

  Give supporting facts, details, and examples



Supporting Sentences:

- These sentences provide details, examples, or explanations that back up the main idea. They help to clarify, elaborate, and add depth to the topic introduced.
- Continuing with the exercise example, supporting sentences might describe how exercise boosts the immune system, increases energy levels, and helps with weight management.

CLOSING SENTENCE

- **What is it?**

  The last sentence in a paragraph
- **What does it do?**

  It restates the main idea
- **How do I write one?**

  Restate the main idea but using different words. The closing sentence should be very similar to the topic sentence.



Concluding Sentence:

- This is the final sentence that wraps up the paragraph and reinforces the main idea. It often summarizes the key points and provides a transition to the next paragraph.
- For instance, a concluding sentence for the exercise paragraph might be, “In summary, regular exercise offers numerous benefits that contribute to a healthier and more active lifestyle.”

